

Action-Prefix Slash Commands

(§11.4.140 LAYER 2 — generated-commands half)

This doc records the Lava-side wiring of the universal action-prefix system (HelixConstitution §11.4.140, adopted by Lava §6.AI + recognized by §6.AJ) as **Claude Code slash commands**, and the honest status of the `.claude/commands/` tracking constraint.

What is already wired (DONE)

- **LAYER 1 (agent self-recognition).** §6.AJ in root `CLAUDE.md` (and the mirror in `AGENTS.md / QWEN.md`) instructs the agent to recognize a `ACTION ::` first-line prefix, look it up in `constitution/actions/registry.yaml`, and expand-then-rescan.
- **LAYER 2 — the hook half.** `.claude/settings.json` (tracked) registers a `UserPromptSubmit` hook pointing at `scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh`, which is thin Lava glue delegating to the canonical expander `constitution/scripts/hooks/action_prefix_expand.sh` (reads `constitution/actions/registry.yaml`). This makes `BACKGROUND :: <task>` expand automatically.
- **LAYER 2 — the generated-commands half for Gemini / Qwen / Codex.** The pinned constitution submodule already ships generated slash commands under `constitution/actions/generated/{gemini,qwen,codex}/` (`background.toml / background.md`, plus `default-background` namespaced aliases), generated by `constitution/scripts/generate_agent_prefix_commands.sh`.

What this doc adds — the Claude Code slash command (`/background`)

The constitution submodule's generator emits Gemini/Qwen/Codex commands but **not** a Claude Code command (Claude Code slash commands live in `.claude/commands/*.md`, an agent-local convention the canonical generator does not target). So Lava provides one:

- **File:** `.claude/commands/background.md` — the bare slash form 3 (`/background <task>`). Its body is **byte-identical** to the canonical expansion rendered in `constitution/actions/generated/codex/background.md` (verified by diff — no §6.J drift bluff). `$ARGUMENTS` carries the task.

Invoking `/background <task>` is equivalent to typing `BACKGROUND :: <task>`: the registered `BACKGROUND` action's expansion is prepended, instructing a subagent-driven, parallel, anti-bluff background work stream.

Tracking constraint — why `.claude/commands/background.md` is NOT committed (OWED)

`.gitignore` line 14 is a blanket `.claude/` ignore:

```
.claude/
```

```
git check-ignore -v .claude/commands/background.md →  
.gitignore:14: .claude/      .claude/commands/background.md.
```

Consequently **the `.claude/commands/background.md` file cannot be tracked / committed** without an explicit un-ignore exception. The file is created in the working tree so the `/background` command is reachable in THIS checkout, but it will not survive a fresh clone.

OWED follow-up (one of)

1. Add a `.gitignore` negation so the command file is tracked, mirroring how `.claude/settings.json` was force-added:

```
.claude/  
!.claude/commands/  
!.claude/commands/*.md
```

then `git add -f .claude/commands/background.md`.

2. OR extend `constitution/scripts/generate_agent_prefix_commands.sh` upstream to also emit a `claude/<name>.md` target + a Lava-side regenerate step that force-adds the result. (Upstream change — NOT done here per the no-edit-pinned-submodule constraint.)

Until one of those lands, the Claude Code slash command is **present in the working tree but untracked** — recorded here as OWED under §6.AI-debt item 2. The `::`-prefix form (`BACKGROUND :: ...`) and the `UserPromptSubmit` hook remain fully functional and tracked, so the action is reachable regardless.

Regenerating after a registry change

The expansion text is sourced from `constitution/actions/registry.yaml` (action `BACKGROUND`). On any registry change, re-derive `.claude/commands/background.md` from `constitution/actions/generated/codex/background.md` (same body) and re-run the diff byte-identity check above.

Classification: project-specific (the Claude Code `.claude/commands/` target + the Lava `.gitignore` constraint are Lava's; the action registry + the generated Gemini/Qwen/Codex commands are universal, inherited from the constitution submodule).